THE WALTHAMSTOW MURDERS.

SENTENCE OF DEATH.

On Friday morning last — before Mr. Justice Day, at the Central Criminal Court—*William Gouldstone*, aged 26, was placed at the bar to take his trial for the wilful murder of his five children, at Walthamstow, on the 8th of last month. It will be remembered that the circumstances of the case were of a peculiarly dreadful nature—the prisoner first drowning the three eldest children in the cistern, and afterwards striking his twin babes over the head with a hammer as they lay in their mother's arms.

Mr. Poland and Mr. Montagu Williams prosecuted on behalf of the Treasury, and Mr. J. P. Grain and Mr. Elliott defended the prisoner.

When placed in the dock the prisoner, who had previously pleaded "Not Guilty," looked carelessly round the Court, and stood calmly, with his thumbs in the sleeveholes of his waistcoat, while the Jury were being sworn.

Mr. Poland having detailed the evidence which would be given,

Ada Hamilton, a monthly nurse, the first witness, was called. She repeated the evidence she gave at the inquest as reported in these columns at the time.—In cross-examination, she said prisoner was very fond of his wife and children; but after the twins were born he seemed very changed. He was always a sober and well-conducted man. — Emma Clarke having given corroborative evidence; p.-c Cheeseman deposed that when he apprehended him the prisoner said, "Good evening, policeman. I have done it now. I am ready for the rope."—P.-c. Wheatly said he sat with the prisoner the first night he was locked up. Prisoner told him he had "had this playing on his mind for a long time."—Medical and other corroborative evidence having been given for the prosecution,

Mr. Grain, for the defence, said, even on the evidence of the prosecution, he would ask the Jury to say that the prisoner was not at the time in a proper state of mind. He would call witnesses to prove that in both branches of the prisoner's family there was undoubtedly hereditary insanity — that his mother was at this time a lunatic, although not confined—and that his aunt and other relations had been insane. It was not confined to the maternal side, but there was also insanity in the father's family, as an own cousin had died a lunatic, as did the father's second cousin and other relations. He thought the Jury would find it their duty to say, under the provision of a new Act of Parliament, that the prisoner did commit the murders, but that he was insane at the time; the result of which verdict would be that he would be detained during her Majesty's pleasure.

Thomas Gouldstone, father of the prisoner; Robert Gouldstone, the eldest brother of the prisoner; Emily Gouldstone, a sister of the prisoner; William Graves, the prisoner's late foreman; Charles Cakebread, a fellow workman; and other witnesses having given evidence which supported Mr. Grain's statements,

Mr. Poland replied, contending that the issue was not whether prisoner was sane, but whether at the time of the murder he knew he was committing a criminal act. Up to August 8th the evidence clearly proved the prisoner had not shown the slightest signs of insanity.

Mr. Justice Day then summed up, pointing out that the sole question the Jury had to determine was whether the prisoner killed the children under circumstances amounting to wilful murder. If he then knew the nature and quality of the act he was committing, he (the prisoner) was guilty of wilful murder.

The Jury then retired, and upon returning into Court after an absence of only fifteen minutes, the Foreman said they found the prisoner Guilty of Wilful Murder.

The Prisoner: I am not guilty.

Mr. Justice Day passed sentence of death in the usual form.

The prisoner, who appeared to be quite unconcerned, was removed to the cells.

THE CONVICT AT THE COUNTY GAOL.

The prisoner arrived at Chelmsford on Friday night, having been brought down by the 8.12 p.m. train, in charge of Mr. Thompson (from the office of Messrs. Gepp and Sons, the Acting Under Sheriffs) and two warders from Springfield Gaol. He was immediately conveyed to the Prison in a cab, and placed in the condemned cell. The dark tweed suit in which the convict was dressed on his arrival at Chelmsford has since been exchanged for the usual prison dress, and his head has been shorn of the light curls which tended to make him somewhat prepossessing in appearance. In height he stands 5ft. 4in.; he is stoutly built, his complexion is fair, and his demeanour stolid and indifferent. A Prison officer is constantly in attendance upon him, two men having been told off for this work—one watching by day, and the other by night—and he is supplied with everything he asks for. In spite of his terrible situation, Gouldstone eats and drinks heartily, and takes his rest with the felicity of a child. On Sunday he attended the ministrations of the Rev. W. F. Lumley, the Gaol Chaplain, at the Chapel; and singularly enough the Psalm for the day (Psalm 79) contained the following verse: "Oh let the sorrowful sighing of the prisoners come before thee; according to the greatness of Thy power preserve thou those that are appointed to die." The verse happens to be an even one (the 12th), and therefore the convict, with the remainder of the prisoners, would repeat it at the service in response to the Clergyman.

INTERVIEW BETWEEN PRISONER AND HIS WIFE.

LETTER FROM THE CONDEMNED MAN.

Mrs. Gouldstone, who is exerting herself to the utmost to save her unfortunate husband's life, writes to state her solemn belief that when the crime was committed the convict was not responsible for his act. She says:—

During our five years married life I frequently noticed that my husband was absent-minded and given to brooding. If he were asked a question he would not, no matter how simple it was, or however easy to answer, reply at once. He would think over it, and sometimes say something not concerning the question. We commenced housekeeping on 21s. a week, and latterly he had 25s. It was sometimes difficult to make ends meet when the children came so rapidly, and this weighed on his mind, I fear, although he never spoke of it to me—except in the way of saying how sorry he was that my hands were so full, and that we could not go out together as we used to do. That was the only way in which he ever spoke of the burthen of the family. Before we had the first child, and right on till the birth of the second, we regularly went to Church. The second child was weakly, and the first was still only a baby, so that we could not leave the house together. For all his occasional absent ways he was very lively, and as I had all to do with the spending of the money, and did not let him know if there was any trouble about payments when there was a confinement or sickness in the house, I always found it very easy to turn his attention to something brighter. He was very kindly with me and the children, handy and willing if they were ailing, and he constantly helped me in household duties. He was a man who had few acquaintances except his own relatives and his fellow-workmen, and he was nearly always at home when not at work, except on the Sunday morning when he occasionally took a walk alone. But for hours together he would keep the children going with his concertina, which he was very fond of playing, while I was engaged in household duties. The children were very fond of him, and never tired listening to the concertina. If he seemed worried, amusing the children—at which he was very good—or a remark from me would at once change his mood. He was painfully aware of how easy it was for him to get worried, and he has often said to me that it was a good job he had not much to think of, as if he had he believed it would turn his brain. Nothing that ever he said or did before the loss of the little ones gave me the least fear that he would take his own life or that of any one else. But shortly before my last babies were born he said to me that he believed he had not many weeks to live, which was a strange remark that I have often thought of since. He never complained, except that he did not know how I should manage with my hands already so full, and soon to be even fuller. But then lots of people manage on less, and we did very well, and when I put this before him he ceased to be moody and absent. I never knew till very lately that there was any insanity in the family. Knowing that now, and looking back on all that has happened, I am certain he was insane, and that the times when I found him sitting thinking lately he was distressing himself about our growing family. You see the eldest was 3½, bright and healthy, but the next, 2½, was sickly and could not walk, and the third, being only 16 months, I had practically two babies to mind when the twins were born. But for all this there was no change in his kindly ways to me and the children. He got up early in the morning of the day when the twins were born, and got me a cup of tea, as he often did before, and did every morning from their birth till their death. The thing that struck me most was that during all this time he never took any notice of the babies. They were born about half-past ten, and he immediately went out of the house, and did not return till after 12. He then came into the room to me, but did not speak. His appearance seemed changed, and his eyes were strange and wandering. He came home early on the day he attacked the poor things, and I asked him if he had told his foreman about the twins, as he had lived with him once, and we looked upon him as one of our own family, but he said he had not. Since the occurrence I have seen my husband three times at the House of Detention, once at the Old Bailey, and on Tuesday last in the Prison at Chelmsford. On each occasion he has been as happy as a child at play. At Chelmsford he said he had seen several relatives whom he had not met for a long time, but neither he nor I made any reference to the fate of the children. His sister and aunt accompanied me yesterday. He asked me to take care of myself, and, turning to his relatives, said, 'You will take care of her, won't you?' Then he said, 'I have broken God's commandment, and I must expect to suffer, but He will forgive me for what I have done.' He realises his position in so far as he believes he will die, but he seems to have no notion of the enormity of killing the children. In a letter I had from him he spoke of them as being in heaven, where he hopes soon to join them. Here is a letter I have from him, dated the 18th, in the same strain:—

"My Dear Wife—I feel it is a Pleasure to Write a few Lines to you and trusting to God that is will find you as well as Can Be Expected after the Dreadful news but I am thankful to God that I feel Happey as I may Expect and I Hope you will Look to God to Help you and He Will Comfort you as well as myselfe Dearest Wife I Hope you will Recive this Letter this Evening and than I Hope you wont fret much about me as what God Doest is for the Best and I Hope you will Be able to Come and See Me Over a Short Time and I Hope Aunt and all at Home are quite Well and all Cousins and Rember me to all that Know me, and Let Cousin Gouldstone in Mash-street know How I am and I am going to Send a few Lines to Mr. G. Sampford and I Hope all Will forgive me for I am thinking about you all But I Hope you all Will Pray to God to Comfort One and all of you and Bear that in mind that God Will forgive all Dear Wife do not fret about what I Have to Live Upon Because I Can Have What I Wish for in my Living from the Prison and you may Belive that the Chappelling will Give me all I Require and I thank God that I Have Been Preparing for the Other World and which I shall do more so now and Live in Hopes to meet you all in Heaven. So Good By God Bless you

"WILLIAM GOULDSTONE.

"Her Majesty's Prison, Chelmsford, Essex,
Sept. 15, 1883."

have no doubt he did not know and could not help what he did. He was always most affectionate to me and the children, and I cannot think that he should suffer a shameful death for what would be to him, if he only understood it, the most awful distress.

The execution will take place at Her Majesty's Prison at Springfield on Monday morning, October the 1st; and it will therefore devolve upon Mr. J. Oxley Parker, the High Sheriff of Essex, to select a hangman in place of Marwood, the late executioner, unless in the meantime a "common hangman" is appointed by the Sheriffs of London and Middlesex. Several applications for the office have been made both at the Gaol and to the High Sheriff.

THE OFFICE OF PUBLIC EXECUTIONER.

Upwards of 1,200 applications have already been received for the post of executioner vacated by the death of Marwood. These have been forwarded from the Home Office and elsewhere, to the Sheriffs of London and Middlesex, who are now engaged in so considering and sifting them as to have a fitting man at hand to carry out the sentence of the law in case of need. The Sheriffs wish it to be particularly known that to reply to so large a number of applications is impracticable, but that original testimonials, where such have been sent, will in all cases be returned in due course.

DUNMOW.

Dunmow Sale Yard.—The fourth monthly sale of live and dead stock was held on Tuesday, the 11th inst., and we understand that, notwithstanding the inclement weather, it passed off satisfactorily, and was the best yet held. The auctioneer, Mr. J. George Cole (who we learn was several years with Messrs. Franklin and Son, the well-known auctioneers), will hold his next sale on Tuesday, October 16th. The facilities offered to vendors and buyers should be an inducement for the inhabitants of the district to patronise these auctions.

Harvest Thanksgiving at the Congregational Church.—On Sunday, the 16th inst., harvest thanksgiving services were held in the Congregational Church, when two impressive sermons were preached by the Pastor (the Rev. J. Barton Dadd), the subjects of the discourses being, "Tearful sowing; joyous reaping," and "The farmer who made the best of this world only." The texts were taken from Psalm cxxvi. 6, in the morning; and in the evening from St. Luke xii. 16 to 21. The decorations of the Chapel were excellent. Liberal contributions of corn, fruit, and flowers given by friends in the congregation, and some fine hops sent to the Pastor by his friends in Kent, were most tastefully arranged under the management of Mrs. Dadd, the Misses Hasler, Piper, Mackenzie, and Mrs. Dalgue, assisted by several other friends. Large congregations were present during the day, and the collections, which were in aid of the Essex Home Missionary Society, amounted to £11 9s. 7d.

The Recent Outbreak of Diphtheria.—The following are copious extracts from the report to the Local Government Board of Dr. Airy, who visited Dunmow on the 18th of May last, respecting the outbreak of diphtheria in the town and district:—

> Up to the time of my visit there had been, as far as was known, since the beginning of the year, about 35 cases of diphtheria in the Dunmow Rural Sanitary District, of which no fewer than 20 proved fatal, including three which were registered as "malignant sore throat." Two additional cases since arose in a family already infected. Twenty-three of the 35 cases had occurred in the parish of Great Dunmow (population 3,005); the remaining 13 in neighbouring parishes. Of these 13 outlying cases the greater number showed no connection with those in Great Dunmow. One group in particular, in the parish of Hatfield Broad Oak, comprising six cases, five of them ending fatally, will claim special attention in this respect.

Dr. Airy then gives a history of the outbreak, and mentions incidentally that the death register of the Dunmow sub-district, which includes the town, records only two deaths from diphtheria in the last ten years previous to 1883. He concludes his remarks on the epidemic in Dunmow thus:—

> The outbreak in Great Dunmow, I think, gives plain indication of having been caused by sewer air escaping in the boys' closets at the National School, and of having been spread chiefly by close personal contact, especially among scholars in class four, and among children of the same family.

After touching upon the cases which occurred at Little Dunmow and Great Canfield, and mentioning at greater length a "curious group of cases presenting a similar concurrence or confusion of scarlet fever and diphtheria" at Taverner's-green, Hatfield Broad Oak, Dr. Airy goes on to say:—

> The sanitary condition of Great Dunmow is far from satisfactory. Sewers have been laid at various times to drain different small sections of the town. They have a comparatively short course, and they discharge at convenience into the nearest ditches, among the gardens and outlying cottages on the lower side of the main street. The ditches communicate with the river Chelmer, which is visibly polluted thereby. The sewers are not ventilated. Other parts of the town cannot be said to have any sewerage at all, each property being drained into the nearest ditch, causing offensive nuisances. One of these ditches discharges, by culvert, into the large pond near the National School. At Church-end, an outlying suburb to the north, there is, close at the back of some cottages on the other side of the river, a very filthy and offensive sewer ditch, discharging directly into the river. Water for all purposes is obtained chiefly from wells of various depths, sunk in the bed of gravel on which the town stands. Where the situation is at a distance from privies, &c., the water is said to be of good quality.

The Doctor observes that the office of Medical Officer of Health for the Dunmow Rural Sanitary District is at present vacant, and that "the duties of Inspector of Nuisances are intelligently and efficiently performed by Mr. J. Hamilton, of Great Dunmow. His salary has been reduced." The report closes with the following recommendations:—

> 1. The Sanitary Authority should take skilled engineering advice as to the best way of dealing with the sewage of the town, so as to abate the nuisances at present existing in connection therewith. 2. The nuisance caused by the large pond near the National School should be abated.

A Ticket of Leave Revoked.—Charles Gaydon was removed from Springfield Prison on Monday, the 17th inst., to H.M. Convict Prison, Pentonville, in charge of Warder Gannon, to undergo the unexpired term of his imprisonment, his license having been revoked. It will be remembered that the prisoner was recently guilty of most disorderly conduct during Divine Service at the Chapel of Dunmow Union-house.

A Fact Well Worth Knowing.

THOS. TAYLOR'S, IRONMONGER, MARKET HILL, SAFFRON WALDEN, is the CHEAPEST and BEST HOUSE in the NEIGHBOURHOOD for ALL CLASSES of IRONMONGERY. Twenty per cent. can be saved by purchasing from him direct. He is now selling a FOUR-TINED DIGGING FORK, warranted, for 1s. 8d.; also 40" SCYTHES, warranted, for THREE SHILLINGS. T. T. has some Splendid MACHINE OIL at 2s. 6d. per gallon.

SAFFRON WALDEN.

Foot-and-mouth disease has broken out at Sparrows End Farm, occupied by Mr. Chas. M. Wade, solicitor. Five Alderneys have been affected since Sunday last, and the premises have since been declared infected. This is the only case we have heard of in the parish at present.

BOROUGH PETTY SESSION, Sept. 18.

Magistrates present:—The Mayor (John S. Robson, Esq.), and T. D. Green, J. G. Emson, and Joshua Clarke, Esqrs.

Drunk and Disorderly.—*George Taylor* and *George Auger*, of Saffron Walden, labourers, were summoned for being drunk and disorderly in Castle-street on Sunday, Sept. 9th, where they were found by p.-c. Woodcock.—Caroline, wife of George Buttle, said she heard Auger tell Taylor to get out of his house, but he did not go, and then Auger put him out.—Taylor, who did not appear, was sentenced to a month's hard labour; and Auger was fined 20s., with costs; or 14 days.

COUNTY PETTY SESSION, Sept. 15.

Magistrates present:—The Right Hon. Lord Braybrooke and Cecil J. Stephens, Esq.

This was the adjourned general annual licensing day, and the following renewals were made—viz., to the Horse Shoes Inn, at Wicken; and a wine license to Mr. Jno. Kettle, of Great Chesterfield.

Stansted Overseer.—Mr. W. H. Kidd, of Stansted, was appointed by the Bench Assistant-Overseer of the parish of Birchanger, at the salary of £10 a-year. He had been nominated Assistant-Overseer of Stansted, and asked the Bench now to formally appoint him to that office; but as he had not brought with him any evidence of his nomination, the appointment by the Bench was left over till next Bench-day.

Assault.—*Geo. Potter*, of Quendon, a gamekeeper, was summoned for assaulting Henry Smith, of Rickling, beerhouse-keeper, on the 6th September.—As the defendant did not appear in answer to the charge, a warrant was issued for his apprehension.

Charge of Fruit Stealing.—*Edward Kirby* and *Walter Kirby*, both of Elmdon, labourers, were charged with stealing some damsons, of the value of 2d., the property of Henry Dean, of Elmdon; and as they both stated that they claimed the fruit, the case was adjourned to the next Bench-day.

Assault on an Innkeeper.—*William Hammond*, of Arkesden, a farmer, was charged with assaulting Andrew Edward Uncle, of Clavering, on the 31st ult.—Mr. Uncle stated: I keep the Fox and Hounds Inn at Clavering. On the day named, at about half-past nine in the evening, defendant came to my house and began to use very bad language. I asked him to leave off, or he would have to leave the house. He still continued to do so, and then struck at my face three or four times with his hand, and he struck me on the head. — Cross-examined: You accused me of using bad language to your wife. I did not put an indecent question to her. I asked your wife to draw me some ale, and she said she could not until her husband came out of the field, and I said, "If you go and get me some ale he will know nothing about it." I did not put any improper questions to her.—Re-examined: On the 6th of August I and others had been at defendant's house, and I paid for three or four quarts.—The evidence of the complainant was corroborated by Simeon Green, who saw defendant swing his arm round and hit Uncle on the elbow.—*Fined* 1s., and costs 17s.

BLACKMORE.

A very successful harvest festival was held in this parish on Tuesday, September 18th. The fine old Church was tastefully decorated, and a large congregation assembled. Prayers were said by the Vicar (the Rev. T. R. Hoskin), the lessons read by the Rev. E. J. Reeve, M.A., Rector of Stondon and Rural Dean, and the Rev. W. H. Bond, M.A., Rector of High Ongar, the latter of whom afterwards preached an admirable sermon from Psalm cxlv. 15, bringing out clearly and impressively the various lessons of harvest-tide. Great and general admiration was expressed for the decorations, which were very beautiful. Among the willing workers were Mrs. Disney, who took charge chiefly of the Sacrarium, and was assisted by her niece, Miss Bainbridge; the Misses Disney, who adorned the windows and side aisles; Mr. E. Seymour Jones and Miss Clara Hoskin, who decorated the font and west end; Miss Crews, the pulpit and prayer desk; Miss Looker, Miss Chapman, and others, who festooned the pillars with ivy and vine branches. The Vicar must have been much gratified by the readiness and heartiness with which all classes gave themselves to assist in the good work. Fruit, flowers, vegetables, and corn were sent in profusion; several of the tradesmen gave freely of their time and material; and even the poor brought of their harvest gleanings and garden flowers to assist in making their Holy House look suitable to the harvest joy. The Choir sang in procession from the vestry, "Come, ye thankful people, come," and on returning to the vestry, "We plough the fields, and scatter." Other hymns and canticles were also well rendered. It is proposed to continue the thanksgiving services on Sunday. The offertory amounted to £6 5s. 4d., and was devoted to the Fund for putting a new heating apparatus in the Church.

COLCHESTER.

Notice.—The Essex Weekly News can be obtained in Colchester every Friday morning of Mr. T. Warner, news agent, 130, High-street; and of Miss Sallows, news agent, 8, Crouch-street, and 4, Long Wyre-street; also at Messrs. Smith and Son's Bookstalls, Railway Station. *Advertisements for this Paper can be forwarded through either of these Agents.*

The Revision of Voters' Lists.—Mr. Octavian Baxter Cameron Harrison, the Revising Barrister, sat at the Borough Court in the Town Hall on Monday, the 17th inst., to revise the lists of voters for the Borough for both the Parliamentary and Municipal elections.—Mr. A. M. White and his son (Mr. C. E. White) appeared for the Conservatives for the three Wards (the 1st, 2nd, and 3rd Wards); and on behalf of the Liberals, Mr. J. W. Potter appeared for the 1st Ward, Mr. Thompson Smith for the 2nd Ward, and Mr. Asher Prior for the 3rd Ward.—The business was got through with greater dispatch than might have been expected, seeing that the claims and objections were three times as heavy as on previous occasions. The Barrister remarked that it was probable that since the last election the two political parties had been waking up and looking more closely than usual into the different cases—a course which is to be recommended.

A Native Shipwrecked.—The emigrants on board the St. Leonard, which was run down on Monday off the Start, while bound for New Zealand, included Mr. H. Weir, of Colchester, a second-class passenger, who is said to have lost £300 with the ship.

Courageous Conduct.—About midday on Saturday, the 15th inst., a carrier's van, belonging to Mr. Everitt, from Wakes Colne and Chappel, arrived at the Bull Inn, Crouch-street, and the passengers had all alighted, with the exception of a little girl named Flux, when the horse bolted. Going up Head-street at a furious pace, it was fast approaching the declivity of North-hill, when Mr. George Siggers, son of Mr. W. G. Siggers, cab proprietor, Sir Isaac's-walk, and an apprentice to Mr. H. Barritt, chemist, rushed out and endeavoured to seize the animal's head. He was thrown down instantly, one of his hands was trodden upon by the horse, and his arm was slightly injured by the wheel as he quickly endeavoured to roll himself out of danger. Although he was unable to stop the horse, his interference diverted its course from the North Hill into the High-street, where it ultimately pulled up before causing any serious damage.

Foot-and-Mouth Disease.—On Saturday, the 15th inst.—before the Colchester County Magistrates—a considerable number of cases of foot-and-mouth disease were reported, including the following:—200 sheep and two lambs, the property of Mrs. Julia Eagle, Brightlingsea Hall; 57 cattle, the property of Mr. Edward Salmon, South House Farm, Fingringhoe; 13 bullocks, the property of Mr. G. D. Smith, Dedham; 25 bullocks, at Lower Meadow, Rivers Hall, Boxted, the property of Mr. James Halls, Great Horkesley; and 40 bullocks, the property of Mr. Fennell, Fingringhoe.

Alleged Offence Under the Cattle Diseases Act.—At the Samford Petty Session, on Tuesday last, *Mr. John Fenner*, farmer, of Stratford St. Mary, was charged under the Contagious Diseases (Animals) Act with having neglected to give notice of an outbreak of foot-and-mouth disease upon his farm.—Mr. H. Jones (Colchester) defended.—Superintendent Fisher deposed to seeing a herd of 48 cattle on defendant's land near the river, all of which were, or had been, suffering from disease.—Mr. A. J. Shorton, veterinary surgeon, Ipswich, and p.-c. Hubbard corroborated as to the state of the cattle.—P.-c. Jillings stated that on August 30th he received notice from defendant that eight of the animals were diseased; and p.-c. Cressy deposed to warning defendant that the land facing his was infected.—Mr. Jones, for the defence, contended that there was no evidence to support the charge. Mr. Fenner's son did not discover the disease until five o'clock on the morning of the 30th, when he immediately went off to report its existence, first to the Essex police and then to the Suffolk police. The scientific evidence which would be called would prove that the disease could not have existed longer ago than a month at the most. 29 of these bullocks had been at Chelmsford Market, and were not put on the meadow until the 29th.—Mr. Fenner and his bailiff, J. F. Roberts, were called to substantiate Mr. Jones's statement generally; while Mr. P. Cowan, Mr. T. J. Poulton, and Mr. James Worsley, Inspectors for Essex under the Contagious Diseases Act, stated that 19 of the cattle were free from disease, and the others had suffered quite recently.—Supt. Daunt deposed that defendant's son gave notice that some of the animals were diseased; and the Magistrates dismissed the case, but made no order as to costs.

Board of Guardians.—The weekly meeting of this Board was held on Tuesday last. Present:—Mr. Edward Smith (Chairman); Messrs. J. Coppin and James Wicks (Vice-Chairmen); Messrs. James Brown, W. Butcher, R. P. Blyth, H. J. Church, W. T. Count, Herbert Cant, Chas. Hawkins (auctioneer), H. Leaning, T. Page, A. J. Prior, G. Rickword, Robt. Sanders, T. Wyncoll, and T. Willson; with Mr. A. E. Purkiss (Assistant Clerk).—On the motion of Mr. Wicks, seconded by Mr. Count, votes of thanks were passed to the Chairman (Mr. Smith) for the use of his grounds for the recent treat to the inmates; to the Master and Matron, and the Schoolmistress, for their assistance in connexion with the treat; and to the cab proprietors who kindly conveyed a number of the old inmates to and from the grounds.

Town Council.—A special meeting of the Town Council was held on Tuesday, the 18th inst., "to receive a report from the Sanitary and Main Drainage Committee on the accounts between the Urban Sanitary Authority and Messrs. Bintley and Son, the contractors for the new Sewerage Works, and to deal with such report; and if so decided to arrange for and sanction a final settlement of the said accounts."—The Mayor (Alderman J. B. Harvey) occupied the chair; and there were present—Alderman H. S. Goody; Councillors T. M. Bear, F. A. Cole, J. B. Daniell, Alfred Francis, Henry Goody, John Lay, and Asher Prior; with Mr. F. B. Philbrick (Town Clerk), Mr. H. C. Wanklyn (Assistant Town Clerk), Mr. Bright Wool (Borough Treasurer), Mr. C. Clegg (Borough Surveyor and Engineer).—The report was read, and it having been received, Mr. Henry Goody moved the following resolution, saying he gathered from the report that there was a large attendance of the Committee on the previous evening, and that they were unanimous in recommending this course, and that fully confirmed him in moving this resolution:—

> That, in the opinion of this Council, it is desirable that the arrangement for settlement of the accounts between Messrs. Bintley and Son and this Authority should be adopted, and they are hereby adopted accordingly; that the said two several certificates for £1,2[illegible] 3s. 6d. and £1,014 15s., respectively mentioned in the said report, be paid, as well also as the said sum of £178 9s. agreed on by Messrs. Bintley and Son as the sum to be accepted by them in full discharge of all claims and demands whatsoever (except percentage moneys retained), which they have already or could allege against the Authority for all matters and things done and supplied by them both under, and extra, and independent of the contract existing between them and this Authority whether in respect of the New Main Drainage and Sewerage Works, or the new road to the Outfall Works, or either of them or otherwise; that the bond of Messrs. Bintley and Son and their surety be cancelled and given up to them, and that the Town Clerk be hereby instructed to see the proper carrying out of this arrangement on the part of this Authority, taking care that on the giving up of these several certificates, and the order for payment of this sum of £178 9s. and the said bond, the Authority are duly discharged by all necessary parties.

—Mr. J. B. Daniell seconded the resolution, which was carried unanimously.—*Mr. Francis* moved the following resolution:—

> That this Authority further approves and adopts the suggestion in the said report that the question of the payment of the percentage moneys retained should be considered without delay, and refers that matter back to the Sanitary and Main Drainage Committee, that they may report thereon to the next monthly meeting of the Council.

—Mr. J. B. Daniell seconded the resolution, which was also carried unanimously; and the meeting broke up.

BOROUGH MAGISTRATES' SITTINGS.

FRIDAY.

Before W. Buck, Esq.

Biting a Policeman's Thumb.—A soldier named *Stephenson*, belonging to the A Troop, 7th Hussars, was charged with being drunk and disorderly and assaulting the police.—The prisoner occasioned a good deal of annoyance at the Bull, and had to be expelled. It required three policemen to take him to the Station, and on the way, after several ineffectual attempts, he managed to get the thumb of police-constable Alexander in his mouth and bit it savagely.—Remanded.

SATURDAY.

Before the Mayor (J. B. Harvey, Esq.) and John Kent, Esq.

William Stevenson, a private in the A Troop of the 7th Hussars, was charged with being drunk and disorderly at the Bull Inn, Crouch-street, on Thursday evening, and refusing to quit when requested. He was also charged with assaulting police-constable G. Alexander at the same time and place, by severely biting his thumb.—The officer, it was stated, would not be able to go on duty for at least a week.—For being drunk the defendant was fined 20s., and costs, with the option of a month's imprisonment, and for the assault on the constable he was sentenced to three months' hard labour.

Annie Isom, an unfortunate, living in Maidenburgh-street, was sentenced to 21 days' hard labour for being disorderly in High-street on Friday night.

MONDAY.

Magistrates present:—The Mayor (J. B. Harvey, Esq.); E. Roberts and J. Kent, Esqrs.

Assaulting the Police at a Fire.—*Francis Albert Woods*, painter, of St. John's-green, pleaded guilty to assaulting p.-c. Geo. Alexander, while on duty at the fire in St. John's-street on Sept. 8th; and was fined 10s. and 12s. costs, or seven days' hard labour.

Alleged Robbery by a Bailee.—*Elizabeth Newland*, alias *Hawkins*, a widow, living in Childwell-alley, was charged with stealing, as bailee, on the 12th inst., two blankets, one sheet, and two pillow-cases, the property of Thomas Raven, labourer, Military-road. — Defendant lived with a man as his wife at the prosecutor's house, and after occupying the rooms for 18 weeks she left, owing to a quarrel with her paramour, and after she had gone the articles were missed. The efforts of the police to trace the property had been ineffectual; and the Bench, considering the evidence inconclusive, discharged her at the same time intimating that should any fresh evidence be discovered, she might be re-arrested.

Robbing a Fellow Lodger. — *Frederick Boyden*, a young bricklayer's labourer, was charged with stealing a silver Geneva watch, a silver chain, and a pair of boots, value £3 15s., the property of Arthur Philip Saunders, a letter sorter at the Post-office, on the 15th inst.—Prosecutor said he and the prisoner lodged and slept together in East Stockwell-street. On Saturday witness returned from duty at four a.m. and went to bed, leaving his boots downstairs and his watch and chain hanging on a nail in the bedroom. When he awoke, about eight o'clock, the watch and chain were gone, as was also the prisoner, and on going downstairs he found the boots gone also.—Prisoner was remanded, in order to give the police an opportunity of recovering the watch.

YESTERDAY (THURSDAY).

Before the Mayor (J. B. Harvey, Esq.); Lieut.-Col. Mathison; and E. Roberts, J. Kent, T. Moy, and W. Buck, Esqrs.

Obstructing Salvationists.—*Alfred Clubb*, labourer, Hythe-hill, and *Simon Wyatt*, Parson's-land, were charged with obstructing the free passage of a footpath leading from Colchester to Wivenhoe.—Mr. Asher Prior was for the complainant, William Fuller, blacksmith, of Horkesley, a Sergeant in the Salvation Army, who stated that on Sunday morning, while on his way to Wivenhoe, accompanied by other officers, to hold a service, he found defendants leaning on a gate at the Maltings, New Quay. They declined to let them pass, and threatened to "chuck them in the river." The Salvationists managed, after half-an-hour's altercation, to pass through; but Mr. Prior remarked that no doubt the collection at the service suffered in consequence of the delay. [Laughter.]—The Mayor said it did not matter who it was that wanted to pass; it was a case of wilful obstruction, and defendants would be each fined 10s., and 5s. costs.

Robbery by a Lodger.—*Frederick Boyden*, bricklayers' labourer, East Stockwell-street, was charged with stealing on the 15th a silver watch, a silver chain, and a pair of boots, value £3 15s., the property of A. P. Saunders, postman, East Stockwell-street, with whom prisoner lodged. Prisoner was apprehended in St. Botolph's by p.-c. Edwards, when he admitted the theft.—Sentenced to six weeks' hard labour.

Smoke or Drink?—*William Lingley*, innkeeper, Groton, was charged by p.-c. H. Frost with being drunk while in charge of a horse and cart in Wyre-street.—Defendant: I wasn't the worse for drink, Sir. It was the smoke. [Laughter.] It allers do turn me up. [Laughter.]—Fined 10s. and 4s. 6d. costs.

Throwing Bricks.—*Elijah Langley*, labourer, Golden Acre, for throwing bricks in St. Botolph's to the danger of the public, was fined 10s. and 11s. 6d. costs; or 14 days.

COUNTY MAGISTRATES' SITTING,

SATURDAY.

Before the Rev. W. Walsh (Chairman); Capt. Brett, Col. Thackeray; John Bateman, H. R. Edwards, John W. Lay, W. Macandrew, W. H. Penrose, and E. Roberts, Esqrs.

James Scott, labourer, Wormingford, was summoned for assaulting and threatening his wife on the 2nd inst.—For the assault he was fined 10s. and 10s. expenses, with the option of 14 days' hard labour. He was also ordered to be bound over—himself in £5, and one surety in £5—to keep the peace for six months, and to pay 8s. 6d. additional costs.

John Smith, labourer, Wakes Colne, was summoned by Mr. Charles Green, farmer, of the same parish, for breach of contract, £5 being claimed as compensation.—The defendant, who did not appear, contracted for a harvest with the plaintiff, but only worked for two days, at the end of which time he left.—Plaintiff did not wish to press for heavy damages; and the Bench ordered the defendant to pay £2 compensation and 8s. 6d. costs, the option being a warrant of distress.

DEDHAM.

The Congregational Church of Dedham held its harvest thanksgiving service on Tuesday, the 18th inst. At the tea the Schoolroom was crowded in every part, and at the public meeting the Chapel was filled with an attentive audience. Mr. R. Scott, of Birchwoods, occupied the chair. The Revds. T. Batty (Colchester), G. C. Postans (Chelmsford), E. Wyatt (Harwich), and Mr. L. Hooper (Bergholt) delivered earnest and instructive addresses upon subjects appropriate to the festival. Some harvest hymns and anthems were well rendered by the Choir. The Chapel was most effectively decorated with fruit, flowers, and corn, the *tout ensemble* being in every way pleasing to the eye. A collection was made at the close for the funds of the Essex and Colchester Hospital.

MANNINGTREE.

Harvest Festival.—A harvest thanksgiving service was held in the parish Church on Sunday evening, the 16th inst., when the Vicar, the Rev. C. A. M. Baley was assisted in the lessons and prayers by the Rev. H. K. Green, Rector of Lawford. An earnest and appropriate sermon was preached by the Rev. C. F. Norman, Rector of Mistley-with-Bradfield and Rural Dean, from the words "Bless the Lord O my soul, and forget not all His benefits." — The collection amounted to £4 10s. 6d.

MISTLEY.

MISTLEY PETTY SESSION, Sept. 17.

Magistrates present:—The Rev. C. F. Norman (Chairman), Canon Marsden; T. W. Nunn, E. Kensit Norman, and J. Woodgate, Esqrs.

Foot-and-Mouth Disease.—Inspector Simmonds reported an outbreak of foot-and-mouth disease at Redberry Farm, Ardleigh, in the occupation of Mr. C. H. Smith, four cows and six steers being affected.—The usual order declaring the district infected was made by the Bench.

Removal of a Pauper.—Mr. R. S. Daniel, Clerk to the Guardians, applied for a Justices' order to remove Francis James Mock from Tendring Union to Barnstaple Union, where he has a settlement.—Granted.

House Water Supply.—*Wm. Henry Eade*, of Kirby, was summoned by Mr. R. S. Daniel, Clerk to the Rural Sanitary Authority, for permitting a new house to be inhabited before obtaining the necessary certificate of health, stating that a supply of wholesome water was obtainable.—Defendant pleaded ignorance of the law; and was fined 1s. and 11s. 4d. costs.—Paid.—*Wm. Day*, of Great Clacton, summoned for a similar offence, was ordered to pay the costs, 11s. 4d.

Salvation Army Disturbances.—*John Pearson*, *Fred. Spendley*, *Wm. Salmon*, *Fred. Spencer*, *Thos. Carrington*, *Wm. Carrington*, *Fred. Palmer*, *Chas. Porter*, *Fred. Cant*, *George Bloom*, and *Jas. Rogers*, lads, residing in Manningtree, and *Priv. Bones*, of the Essex Regiment, were charged by "Captain" Ada Smith with disturbing the service at the "Salvation Barracks," at Manningtree, on September 10th.—Mr. Asher Prior prosecuted on behalf of the Army; and Mr. Armstrong appeared for the defendants, who were fined 2s. 6d. and 7s. 6d. costs each. —*Robert Parker* and *William Proom* were charged with riotous behaviour in the Salvation Hall on the evening of Sept. 2nd.—Parker was fined £1, and Proom 5s., and each to pay 10s. 6d. costs.—*Robert Parker* was also charged with assaulting Alice Hodges, a "Lieutenant" of the Salvation Army, by kissing her on August 21st.—Mr. Asher Prior prosecuted, and Mr. Armstrong defended.—Defendant was fined 5s., and 13s. costs.

Stealing Apples.—*Eunice Sage*, a boy ten years of age, was charged by Mr. Samuel Ellis with stealing growing apples, valued at 6d., and also with breaking and carrying away a portion of complainant's fence.—Fined 1s., 6d. damage, and 9s. 6d. costs.—14 days allowed.

Alleged Assault.—*George Vincent*, blacksmith, of Manningtree, was summoned by Elizabeth Marven for assaulting her on Sept. 5th.—Mr. Armstrong prosecuted.—The case was dismissed, the costs being remitted.

LAYER MARNEY.

Dedication and Harvest Festival.—The harvest festival and dedication services were held at the parish Church of S. Mary the Virgin on Thursday, the 13th inst., commencing with Holy Communion at 8 a.m. At Evensong the sacred edifice (the altar, screen, pulpit, and font of which were appropriately decorated) was completely packed with a very attentive congregation, the majority of whom joined most heartily in the service, in which the following Clergy took part and walked in the procession:—The Revds. F. J. R. Laurence (Rector of Birch and Rural Dean), Dr. Hill (Rector of Stanway), F. Watson (Rector of Great and Little Wigborough), A. C. Fenn (Rector of Tiptree), R. D. Long (Rector of Inworth), and A. F. Evans (Curate of Coggeshall). The Rector sang the first part of the prayers, and the Rev. A. F. Evans the last. Dr. Hill read the first lesson, and Mr. Laurence the second. An able and appropriate sermon was preached by the Rev. Howell Blood from the text, St. Matthew iv. 4.—The offertories, which were for the Essex and Colchester Hospital, amounted to £3 15s.—a goodly sum for a very small parish.

BISHOP STORTFORD.

Mr. T. J. Mann, of The Grange, has been elected to fill the vacancy on the Bishop Stortford Local Board, caused by the death of Mr. Hy. Tucker.

Common Tern at Farnham.—Mr. T. J. Mann, of Bishop Stortford, sends the following to the *Field*:—"A specimen of the common tern (Sterna hirundo), a bird of the year, was found on Aug. 31st in a ditch, in a very exhausted condition, at Farnham, Essex. As this species is migratory, it may, in seeking its southern winter resort, have lost its usual power of flight from want of its natural food. It is seldom that its appearance has been recorded so far from the sea, and the fact seems worthy of notice. The bird is still alive, but there is considerable difficulty in finding a proper substitute for its usual fare, the lack of which will, I fear, soon prove fatal."

Fire at Albury Hall.—A fire broke out early on Monday morning, the 17th inst., in the stack-yard adjacent to Albury Hall, the residence of Mr. W. S. Shoobridge, J.P., and damage amounting to between £500 and £600 was done—a very large hay-stack (the produce of about 100 acres), a large barley stack, some barley draggings, and a quantity of straw being destroyed. The buildings and other stacks close by had a narrow escape. Efficient help was rendered by the Bishop Stortford Volunteer Fire Brigade, who attended with an engine. The fire, it is believed, arose through the over-heating of the hay-stack. The property was not insured.

GREAT BARDFIELD.

Foot-and-Mouth Disease.—A fresh outbreak of foot-and-mouth disease has been reported during the past week from Bluegate Hall Farm, Great Bardfield, in the occupation of Mr. W. S. Nurmann, where four cows are affected.

BOOT AND SHOE WAREHOUSE, HIGH STREET, MALDON.
J. TIFFEN

BEGS to inform the public that he is SOLE AGENT for Maldon of the Celebrated ANHYDROUS WATERPROOF K BOOTS, for walking, shooting, and fishing. Specially prepared to withstand the effects of rain, snow, and mud, and to ensure the wearer against the ailments which are constantly arising from damp feet. The sole and upper leather is specially prepared by the patent process ordered by the Admiralty for the Arctic Expedition. N.B.—Ladies and Gentlemen's Boots and Shoes Neatly Repaired with the Anhydrous Waterproof Leather on the Premises.

WILLIAM CLARK,
HIGH STREET, MALDON,

IS SHOWING some REMARKABLY CHEAP CLOTHING, HATS, and BOOTS for ready money only.
SPECIAL BOOT for BOYS and GIRLS.
The Patent Indestructible Toes.

FOR HIGH-CLASS PHOTOGRAPHY,
PAY A VISIT TO
WALTER W. GLADWIN,
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MALDON.

OUTDOOR PHOTOGRAPHY of every description. GROUPS and EQUESTRIAN PICTURES. Instantaneous Photography only. Telegrams receive special and prompt attention. Copies, Enlargements, and Paintings, produced in best possible manner. New Series of Views of Maldon and Neighbourhood.

MALDON.

SHIPPING RETURN, MALDON, Sept. 19.

ARRIVED.

Name.	*Master.*	*From.*	*Cargo.*
Livonia	Fulcher	Ipswich	Iron
Startled Fawn	Laysell	Sunderland	Coals
Oak	Eves	Grays	Chalk
Diligent	Eves	Grays	Chalk
Minerva	Raven	London	Maize, &c.
Eva Annie	Keeble	London	Oats, &c.
John	Dinsdale	Whitstable	Light
Rose	Hales	London	Timber
Eastwood	Gooch	Harwich	Timber
Fanny	Hales	Grays	Chalk

SAILED.

Name.	*Master.*	*For.*	*Cargo.*
Robert Adamson	Bell	Sunderland	Ballast
Elizabeth	Hargrave	Leeds	Wheat
Neptune	Kerridge	Goole	Wheat
Andromedia	Howlett	Ipswich	Light
Henry	Mizzen	Burnham	Light
Energy	Phillips	Bradwell	Oats, &c.
Eleanor	Turner	Blyth	Ballast
James & Harriet	Handley	London	Hay & straw
Livonia	Fulcher	London	Light
Ann Elizabeth	Surry	London	Mangold
Thomas	Wright	Southend	Deals, &c.
Sarah Lizzie	Laythorpe	Lowestoft	Light
John	Dinsdale	Goole	Wheat
Oak	Eves	London	Light
Falcon	Wright	London	Beans
New Hope	Guymer	London	Wheat

All Saints' Boys' School.—The result of the drawing examination held in July, in connection with the Science and Art Department, South Kensington, has just been received, and is on the whole very satisfactory. All the teachers presented in second grade freehand were successful—Frank Smith being marked "excellent," and Edwin Smith and Robert Ibbs, "good." Of the scholars presented in first grade geometry, the following gained the mark "excellent"—viz., Reg. Cooper, Geo. Eve, Clifford Eve, Fred. Eve, Adolphus Huxtable, Percy Ibbs, and James Jamieson. Those marked "good" are Ernest Burnes, Douglas Hurrell, and Lewis Ibbs. In first grade freehand James Jamieson gained "excellent," and Chas. Bullock, Harry Carter, Hector Collins, Napier Dent, Douglas Hurrell, Adolphus Huxtable, Lewis Ibbs, Joseph Last, Wm. Unwin, and Fred. Wood were marked "good." The remaining 18 were marked "fair," and there was not a single failure. All candidates marked "excellent" receive a prize and a certificate, and those marked "good" receive a certificate. James Jamieson is the first pupil who has succeeded in securing two prizes at any one of these yearly drawing examinations at this School. Frank Smith has now passed in three second grade subjects, and has secured a prize on each occasion.

Fatal Fall from a Stack. — Yesterday (Thursday) Mr. W. Codd, Coroner, held an inquest at Heybridge on the body of James Collier (66), of Heybridge, labourer, who accidentally fell from a stack on which he was working with John Handley and George Cork, on Northlands Farm, on Tuesday, and died the same day from fracture of the skull.

Funeral of the Late Mr. John Joseph Bygrave.—The remains of this lamented gentleman were interred on Wednesday last, in the Cemetery, being the first interment in the large vault erected by the deceased many years since, in ground chosen by himself. The procession was headed by mutes, followed by the hearse, two mourning coaches, and the private carriages of Mr. W. J. Beadel, Springfield Lyons, and Dr. May, Maldon. The coffin was a handsome one of polished oak, with plain ecclesiastical furniture, bearing a plate with the inscription—"J. J. Bygrave, died 14th Sept., 1883, aged 60 years." In the first mourning coach were Mr. John Bygrave (eldest son of deceased) and Mr. G. Richardson and Mr. W. J. Beadel (respectively son-in-law and brother-in-law to deceased). The second coach contained the Rev. E. R. Horwood (Vicar of Maldon, who officiated), Dr. May, and Mr. W. Orick (the family physician and legal adviser). The servants of the deceased also followed in another carriage. Among the large concourse of people were Messrs. H. J. Sanson, A. C. Freeman, J. G. Green, Blaxall, Ottowell, R. Poole, Greatrex, and W. Wright. The funeral arrangements were carried out under the direction of Mr. W. Humphreys, Maldon. Mr. Bygrave had been for many years a Guardian of the poor and a Trustee of Breeder's Charity, and the family are very much respected both in the town and county, as the bearer of an old and honoured name. The death of the deceased occurred rather suddenly. On Friday morning he was walking for exercise in the garden behind his house, and called Mrs. Bygrave's attention to some splendid flowers then in blossom. He was soon after seized with a fit, and died in nine hours, the flowers which he so much admired in life afterwards shedding their quiet beauty upon his coffin.

Strange and Exciting Scene at Heybridge.—On Saturday night, the 15th inst., a man named David Hines, labourer, of Oakeley-green, Tiptree, when under the influence of drink, rushed into the bed of Heybridge Creek, with the avowed intention of drowning himself. He stuck in the mud, and on being seized he was taken in an epileptic fit, and was so violent as to require six or eight men to hold him. Mr. Gutteridge, surgeon, of Maldon, was called in, and he ordered the man to be taken to the Union, where he arrived, senseless, but recovered sufficiently to be discharged next day.

Maldon Reform Club Promenade Concert.—A second promenade concert took place in the Reform Club Gardens on Wednesday evening, the 19th inst., which was well attended, and fun and peace reigned supreme in the hands of the "Maldon Amateur Darkies," whose quips and cranks and capital music elicited alternate applause and laughter. The grounds were gaily illuminated, and there were some excellent fireworks, and dancing to music "supplied" by Bandmaster Allen. Mr. and Mrs. McKiwee, and their son, F. McKiwee, catered energetically for the convivialities of their guests.

LONDON HOUSE,
SOUTHMINSTER.

THE ANNUAL SALE of DRAPERY
Is fixed to Commence on
MONDAY, the 24th inst.,

WHEN some EXTRAORDINARY BARGAINS will be offered to the Public.

This GREAT SALE, which has been established 22 years, is attended by increasing numbers, owing to the many advantages it affords, notably that customers can select from a large stock, and get what they want at a great saving in price.

In addition to the useful HOUSEHOLD DRAPERY of BLANKETS, FLANNELS, SERGES, SHEETINGS, COUNTERPANES, CARPETS, COCOA MATTING, CALICOS, TOWELLING, BED TICK, TABLE CLOTHS, CURTAINS, &c., the SALE will also include a well-assorted stock of men's PILOT JACKETS and COATS, MOLESKINS and CORD TROUSERS, men's and boys' CLOTH KINK SUITS, and STRONG-KNITTED GUERNSEYS, and well-made BOOTS and SHOES.

SHOP CLOSES at SIX O'CLOCK during SALE.
ALL GOODS must be PAID FOR BEFORE REMOVAL.

J. S. PRIOR, Proprietor,
NORTH STREET, SOUTHMINSTER.

SOUTHMINSTER.

Accidents in the Harvest Field.—During the harvest that has just concluded, there have been several accidents from various causes among the labourers in the Dengie Hundred; but, with the exception of one that happened to Mr. Pudney, of the Old Heath, who fell from the top of a load, and was severely shaken, and a similar accident to a man named Goodwin, residing at Asheldham, they were of a minor character.

Death of the Oldest Female Inhabitant.—On Tuesday, the 18th inst., Mrs. Lamprell, the oldest female inhabitant of this village, "passed over to the majority" at the ripe age of 85 years.

Accident to a Boy.—On Monday, the 17th inst., an accident occurred in the road leading to the Marshes. A labourer named Beehag (whose father, G. Beehag, is looker for Mr. John Page, Mayland, and resides at Deal Hall Farm) was driving a horse harnessed to a large water butt, when the horse swerved, throwing the lad over the hedge. Here he was found by two women, and with their assistance he proceeded after his horse, which continued at a terrific speed, and was courageously stopped in the Hall-road by a lad named Alliker, and brought back by Mays, the roadman, who met Beehag, he having been picked up by a lad named Lambert, in the employ of the Misses Spells, bakers. The sufferer was conveyed to Dr. Lailey's, and it was found that he had escaped with a fracture of the ankle and some trifling scratches.

ASHELDHAM.

Thanksgiving Services were celebrated on Sunday, Sept. 16th. The decorations at this Church are always very noteworthy for the skill and care bestowed upon them, but this year they were the most tasteful and pretty that have yet been executed. The ladies who have assisted in this work are the Misses Malden, the Misses Dawes, and Miss Smith. The services were conducted by the Rev. H. P. Dawes, Vicar, who preached impressive sermons founded on Revelations xiv. 15-16, and Psalm lxv. 13. The offertory, for the relief of the infirm and sick poor of the village who have been unable to work in the harvest fields, realized £3 18s. 9d.

STOW MARIES.

Harvest Thanksgiving Services were held here on Sunday, Sept. 17th. The ancient edifice was effectively decorated with corn, fruit, and flowers by the ladies from the Rectory, Mrs. Knight, and the senior members of the Choir; while the texts were the work of Mr. Last. The attendance was not large in the morning, but in the evening both chancel and nave were crowded. The Rev. G. Raynor preached in the morning a very appropriate sermon from Psalm lxv. 12. The Rev. W. Hughes conducted the service in the evening, and preached most eloquently from the text, "They that sow in tears shall reap in joy," &c. The musical portion of the services was heartily rendered by the Choir, who were materially assisted by friends residing for a time in the neighbourhood. The anthem was, "Thou Crownest the Year" (Thos. Smith). The collections were given to the Day School.

BURNHAM.

I.O.G.T.: Burnham "Ark of Safety" Lodge, 1032.—On Tuesday last a very interesting gathering took place in connection with the above Lodge, in the Temperance Hall, the occasion being a fruit banquet, when each member was allowed to invite a friend, which resulted in a large gathering of members and friends. Bro. E. Osborn, W.C.T., was Chairman. A recitation ("The Useful Ghost") was given by Bro. W. Wilkinson, and readings by Bros. T. Warren and E. Dilliway. The Temperance Choir sung several pieces, ably accompanied on the harmonium by Miss Lizzie Dilliway. A pleasing feature was an earnest address by Bro. Kent, of her Majesty's watch vessel Lucifer, who gave an account of his visits to the Fiji Islands, to Australia, America, Canada, the Mediterranean, and his travels round the British Isles, from a temperance point of view. Other addresses were given by Bros. E. B. Trussell, W. Argent, and Mr. Offin. The Temperance Brass Band, under the direction of Bro. Geo. Trussell, played selections of music in a creditable manner.

Trap Accident.—An accident happened on Saturday morning, the 15th inst., to a young man employed by Mrs. Wm. Auger. He was driving a horse and trap, through the High-street, when the animal commenced kicking, breaking the shafts and otherwise damaging the conveyance, and inflicting some slight injuries upon one of its own legs. The young man escaped unhurt.

LATCHINGDON.

Harvest Thanksgiving Services were held here on Sunday, Sept. 16th, when the Church was tastefully decorated by the Misses Formby and Laver. The congregations were good at both services.

TILLINGHAM.

"The (Educational) Rivals."—Some time since the Dissenters in this village opened a School in connection with the Congregational Chapel in a building previously used as a Sunday School. Of course a considerable number of parents sent their children to the new School, especially as the fees were much lower than at the Church School. Last week the following notice was issued by the Managers of the National School:—"The Managers of this School wish it to be generally known that the Education Acts require that all children who are of age to attend School shall, unless specially exempted, attend a duly certified efficient School. The National School is the only duly certified efficient School in the parish, and it re-opens on Monday, September 17th. N.B.—Parents or guardians of all children not receiving instruction as required by the Education Acts are liable to prosecution for neglect of duty.—Signed, Wm. C. Miller, Chairman of Committee." On behalf of the Chapel School a counter "manifesto" has been issued, stating that what the Education Acts really require is, that every child of School age shall receive efficient instruction in reading, writing, and arithmetic, and that they may attend any School where such instruction is provided. This notice is conspicuously exhibited by the side of the other, across which is written in large letters the word "Scarecrow." The controversy has excited considerable discussion.

Congregational Church.—On Tuesday the children belonging to the Sunday and day Schools, numbering upwards of a hundred, had a treat provided for them by a few members and friends of the congregation. They marched through the village to a meadow belonging to Mr. G. Coombe, and after indulging in a variety of sports, the youngsters, with their teachers and friends, sat down to a capital tea. Tea over they again indulged heartily in various sports until the shadows of evening approached. After a few words addressed from the Pastor (the Rev. J. H. Brewster) the children separated, highly pleased with their treat. The whole of the teachers and friends were very grateful to Mr. and Mrs. Coombe for contributing in so great a measure towards the day's enjoyment.

WOODHAM FERRIS.

Charge of Assault.—*Joseph Head*, over 60 years of age, was apprehended by p.-c. A. Brown at Woodham Ferris, on Tuesday, on a charge of assaulting a little girl of about twelve. He was brought before Mr. R. Woodhouse at the Shire Hall, Chelmsford, on Wednesday, and remanded till to-day (Friday).

ESTABLISHED THIRTY YEARS.
J. C. SACH,
UPHOLSTERER AND GENERAL HOUSE FURNISHER,
HIGH STREET, WITHAM, ESSEX.

PAPERHANGINGS, Carpets, Floor Cloths, Cocoa Matting, Mats, Brass and Iron Bedsteads. All kinds of new and SECOND-HAND FURNITURE. Pianofortes for Sale or Hire.

REES BROTHERS, of WITHAM,

ARE NOW OFFERING some Extraordinary BARGAINS in DRAPERY and MILLINERY, and request a visit from their Customers while the Sale is on.

REES BROTHERS,
DRAPERS AND MILLINERS,
WITHAM.

WITHAM.

International Potato Exhibition.—Among the winners of first prizes at the International Potato Exhibition held at the Crystal Palace last Thursday, we notice the name of T. H. Hills, gardener to Mr. A. W. R. Brise, of Durwards, Witham, for the best dish of any coloured skin potato.

Accident.—On Thursday evening, the 13th inst., a thatcher named Challis was riding a horse near the Cherry Tree Inn, Chipping Hill, when the animal reared and fell over with him, breaking his leg.

Foot-and-Mouth Disease.—We regret to state that two cases of foot-and-mouth disease have appeared in this district during the past few days—one at the Warrens farm, Faulkbourne, in the occupation of Mr. W. H. Bullock, four beasts being affected; and the other at Whitelands Farm, Hatfield Peverel, five cows being affected. In both instances strenuous efforts are being made to confine the disease to the district where it has appeared.

An Unbrotherly Act.—On Saturday evening, the 15th inst., a robbery was committed at Chipping Hill by a man named Thomas Turner, a discharged soldier. It appears his brother Henry, a stonemason, had £4 10s. in a box, and Thomas took it and made his way to London by the train from Hatfield Peverel.

A correspondent in a Suffolk contemporary, writing on "The Ipswich of Some Thirty Years Ago," runs off the reel a string of names popular at the Debating Society at Carr-street, and one of his characters is thus described:—"A clever and dashing speaker, full of high spirits and enthusiasm, was Thomas M. Blackie, now the Principal of a High School in Essex."

PATTISWICK.

The Annual Harvest Thanksgiving Services were held in the parish Church on Thursday, the 13th inst. The decorations—by Miss Marion Hanbury and Miss Bartol, assisted by members of the Choir—were very tasteful and effective. The services were very well attended, a large number communicating both at 8 a.m. and 11 a.m. At Evensong the Church was crowded. The sermon was preached by the Rev. D. J. C. Swinny, who is residing at Stisted for a short time. The service was choral, the lessons being read by the Rev. W. Ferry (of Greenstead Green) and the Rector (the Rev. Samuel B. Baird). Miss Chamberlain presided at the organ with great skill and taste. The anthem, "The earth is the Lord's" (Simper), was well rendered. The solo part was taken by the boys, and though it was the first time of singing by themselves, they went through it without a mistake. The greatest credit is due to Miss Chamberlain for the careful and correct way in which she instructs the Choir. The *Te Deum* was sung as a hymn of thanksgiving after the service. The offertories of the day, amounting to £2 7s. 5½d., were devoted to the Essex and Colchester Hospital Fund.

COGGESHALL.

Harvest Thanksgiving Services.—On Sunday evening, the 16th inst., the usual harvest thanksgiving service was held in the Congregational Chapel, when an excellent address was delivered by the Rev. A. D. Philps, upon the words, "Until the harvest." Messrs. Thos. Simpson, Thos. Kettle, and Wm. Mount (Deacons) also took part in the devotional portion of the service. Collections, amounting to £10 6s., were made on behalf of the Congregational Day Schools.

ORSETT.

Foot-and-Mouth Disease. — At the Court House, on Friday, the 14th inst., Inspector Allen reported several fresh outbreaks of foot-and-mouth disease in the division. Three cases had occurred on Colonel Russell's farms at North and South Ockendon; one on Mr. Stevens', at Bulphan Fen; three at Fen Farm, Orsett, belonging to Mr. W. Field; and three at Great Abrahams, Orsett, the property of Mr. Woollings; The places were declared.

Harvest Thanksgiving.—Hearty and well-arranged harvest thanksgiving services took place at Orsett on Sunday, Sept. 16th. The decorations were in excellent taste, and while fruit and flowers were used as ornaments, the various kinds of corn (sent, we believe, from every farm in the parish) formed the principal part of the decoration. The lady workers deserve the highest praise for their diligent and tasteful work. Many of the inhabitants sent fruit and flowers and pot plants, and we noticed one pretty little hop plant which was a perfect picture. On the altar was a beautiful cross, composed of wheat, with a bunch of grapes in the centre; and the pulpit and reading-desk were in great taste. The font was a perfect wealth of harvest produce, and the capitals and screen were wreathed with corn and flowers; while the reredos was beautifully panelled with corn, barley, and oats. The services were well attended throughout the day, 25 communicants being present at 8 o'clock and 52 at the 11 o'clock service, when the Rector preached from I. Timothy iv. 4-5, pointing out that thanksgiving was the necessary act to complete the value of good gifts, and making a special appeal for the funds of the Royal Agricultural Benevolent Society and the Hospitals. At three o'clock the Litany was sung by the Rector, and an excellent sermon preached by the Rev. J. E. Potts. Long before six o'clock the Church began to fill for Evensong, and at 6.30 the Church was full to the doors. The Romford ringers came over and rang several peals before service. The service was fully choral, and was taken by the Rector and the Rev. J. E. Potts, the Rev. T. A. Morley and the Rector reading the Lessons. The anthem was "Ye shall dwell in the land," and the solos by Mr. Thomas Ridgwell and E. Rowley were excellently rendered. The Choir were strengthened by the kindly help of some ladies placed behind the Choir stalls, and the highest credit is due alike to the Choir and the Choirmaster, Mr. John Ridgwell, for the excellent and hearty singing. An excellent sermon was preached by the Rev. Canon Hitchcock, Vicar of Romford, from Hosea ii. 8, and was a masterly handling of the duties of thanksgiving to, and trust in, God. The offertories during the day amounted to about £16, which will be devoted to the Royal Agricultural Benevolent Society and some of the London Hospitals.

Bulphan Parish Church.—Last (Thursday) evening a harvest thanksgiving service took place at the parish Church, Bulphan, when the sermon was preached by the Rev. A. E. Clementi-Smith, Rector of Chadwell St. Mary.

School Treat.—On Monday, the 17th, the Sunday School children of the Primitive Methodist Chapel had their annual treat at Tyrrells Heath Wood. About 150 children, with their parents, and several Ministers, were present, the latter including Mr. Davidson, Mr. Harvey, Mr. Robert Harvey, Mr. Kempster, Mr. Goodwin, and Mr. Hunt. An abundance of cake, tea, and fruit was provided. Amusements of many sorts were indulged in, and all appeared thoroughly to enjoy themselves.

ROMFORD.

THEO. DAVEY, Auctioneer, Surveyor, Valuer, House and Estate Agent, Crown Chambers, and Western-road, ROMFORD. Surveys of Buildings, Land, &c., made. Building Plans and Specifications Prepared. Valuations for Probate, &c., &c.

At the meeting of the Board of Guardians on Tuesday, the 18th inst., it was decided that in view of the Poor Law Conference at Ipswich on the 12th proximo, the Chairman (Mr. W. W. Glenny), the Vice-Chairman (Mr. G. J. Clark), and Mr. J. Roynon be requested to represent the Romford Union on the occasion. The gathering is expected to be of an important character, and amongst the papers to be read is one by our worthy Chairman of Quarter Session, Mr. Andrew Johnston.

Board of Guardians.—At the weekly meeting of the Board on Tuesday last — Mr. W. W. Glenny, J.P., in the chair—the Guardians were occupied for a considerable time in considering the tenders for supplying articles to the House, and for outdoor relief for the ensuing six months; and the following were the tenders accepted:—Bread, per 4lb. loaf, Mr. A. Dodwell, 4½d. First district: Mr. J. Johnson, Barking, 5½d. Second district, Mr. J. Tidmarsh, Romford, 5½d. Flour: Mr. H. Whitmore, 37s. per sack. Meat (10s. per stone of 14lbs.): Mr. H. Blaxall; legs and shins, 4s. 6d. ditto. Barking district—Meat: Mr. T. Beaumont, at 6d. per lb. Ilford district: Mr. A. Ingram, 7d. per lb. Dagenham district: Mr. J. Key, 8d. per lb. Romford district: Mr. H. Blaxall, 8½d. per lb. Hornchurch district: Mrs. Gaywood, 8½d. per lb. Milk (indoor): Mr. S. Nash, Romford, 1s. per gallon. Grocery: Mr. J. Spencer, Romford. Beer: Mr. T. W. Glenny, Barking, 24s. per barrel; porter, 32s. Coals: Mr. G. B. Gilbey, Romford, 16s. 3d. per chaldron; coke, 9s. ditto. Spirits: Mr. P. Reynolds, Romford—gin, 13s. per gallon; brandy, 20s. Haircutting and shaving: Mr. G. Pilborough, £13 the year. Coffins: Second district, Mr. G. Thurgood, 14s., and 7s. for children. Leather: Mr. J. B. Smith, Romford.—The consideration of the tenders for supplying drapery was adjourned for two weeks.

Sudden Death.—On Friday afternoon, the 14th inst., the infant daughter of Mr. G. Ellis, painter, of St. Andrew's-road, expired very suddenly in its mother's lap, from the effects of a convulsive fit. The child was only two months old, but had appeared healthy. Mr. A. Wright, surgeon, was sent for, and was soon in attendance; but the child expired before he arrived. He made an external examination of the body, from which he could not give a certificate. The case was reported to Mr. H. S. Haynes, the Coroner, who ordered a *post-mortem* examination to be made, which was done; and Mr. Wright certified that the child died from natural causes, and thus an inquest was avoided.

Found Drowned.—On Friday evening, the 14th inst., an inquest was held at the Swan Inn—before Mr. H. S. Haynes and a Jury (of whom Mr. Wallis was appointed Foreman)—on the body of a man, name, occupation, and residence unknown, whose body was found floating in Black's Canal that morning.—Harry Seymour Clarke, son of the Master of the Union, deposed: At twenty minutes to nine o'clock this morning I was walking past the canal, and saw the body of a man floating near the bridge, about the centre. I told two boys of it, who went and gave information at the Police-station. I saw no footmarks on the bridge, nor about the footpath or road. The body was upright, and the feet and legs were sticking in the mud.—P.-c. N. Page deposed: I received information about nine o'clock, and proceeded to the canal with a stretcher. I found the feet of deceased fast in the mud, and the face was floating on the water. The body was quite stiff. With the assistance of p.-c. Archer, I got the body out and brought it to the Swan. Deceased was attired in a felt hat, cloth coat, and striped waistcoat. I should take him to be a mechanic. The hands were clean and soft, as if not engaged in hard work. I only found a comb, pocket knife, and handkerchief upon the body. There were no marks upon the handkerchief. A portion of the "East London Reader" was found in one of the pockets, and a small piece of lead pencil. Every inquiry has been made up to the present, but we have not been able to ascertain anything about the deceased.—The Coroner said as there was no evidence to show how the deceased got into the water, their safest course would be to return a verdict of "Found drowned."—The Jury acted on the suggestion of the Coroner.

Gun Accident.—On Wednesday, the 12th inst., Mr. John Groves, of Grays, was out shooting with a party of friends on the estate of Mr. E. Blewitt, at South Hornchurch, when, as he was taking aim at a covey, the gun suddenly exploded and shattered the whole of his left hand. He was conveyed by the next up train from Rainham to the London Hospital, where amputation was performed.

Fire at Hornchurch.—On Monday morning, the 17th inst., a party of Mrs. Woodfine's labourers concluded a task of bean-threshing in one of her fields in the Upminster-road, but incautiously left a heap of chaff and refuse burning within 10 yards of a straw stack belonging to Mr. Brooks, of the Bell Inn, Collier Row. Shortly after the machine had been taken from the field the wind veered towards the stack, which caused some sparks to ignite it, and it was quickly in flames. The threshing party soon returned to the spot, but by that time the flames had got a fast hold. No water was procurable within a quarter-of-a-mile, and in less than 30 minutes the stack was entirely consumed. It consisted of 30 loads, valued at £37; and Mr. Brooks is covered by insurance in the Royal Office.

MR. MATHEW AND THE ROMFORD BOARD OF HEALTH.

A PERTINENT ANSWER.

To the Editor.

Sir,—Having read a letter in your last issue signed "Richard Mathew," I trust you will allow me to state, as my name is mentioned, that I was not "in company" with the Local Board's Surveyor "on the day in question, and that I certainly did not say to Mr. Mathew that "the Surveyor tells me that he is coming again in the afternoon with Dr. Wright;" because I had had no intimation of such visit from the Surveyor or any other person.—Yours truly,

R. PALMER.

BARKING.

A Triple Falsehood.—On Monday, the 17th inst., *James Pratt*, a labourer, of Denmark-road, Barking, was brought before Mr. A. Johnston and Col. Birt, at Stratford, charged with the unlawful possession of a plank, 12ft. in length.—At 3.30 on Sunday morning p.-c. K 456 met prisoner carrying the plank at Mountfield-road, and on asking prisoner how he became possessed of it he said he brought it from his "other house." On asking where that was he replied, "Somewhere up the road." On the way to the Station he said the plank was given him by his brother, who lived at 5, Russell-terrace, Barking. P.-c. Cooke went to the address, but no such person lived there, when prisoner said he bought it of a "strange man" that he met as he came out of the Docks.—The Chairman: You have told three falsehoods.—Prisoner: If you'll put the case off, and let me out, I'll try and find the man I bought it of.—The Chairman: Oh, no; now we have got you we shall not let you go. You are fined 20s.; or 14 days.—Committed in default.

Another Disciple of Munchausen.—*James Smith* (30), of Axe-street, Barking, was charged, at Stratford, on Monday, the 17th inst., with stealing a quantity of cauliflowers, value 4d., from a field at Longbridge Farm, the property of Mr. Thos. Patch.—Prisoner was caught in the act at 3.30 on Saturday evening by p.-c. Stevens, 611 K, when he said that he worked for Mr. Patch, who gave him permission to "pull a few."—Mr. Patch, jun., deposed that his father was ill in bed, and could not have given the permission. Prisoner was a stranger, and never worked on the farm.—Fined, with costs, 14s., or seven days' hard labour; and locked up in default.

Welcoming a New Pastor.—On Thursday evening, the 13th inst., a meeting was held in the Congregational Schoolroom to welcome the new Pastor (the Rev. T. Davies, late of Alsager, Cheshire). Tea was provided, to which about 80 sat down.—Mr. Gregory, senior Deacon, presided over the evening meeting; and after an opening prayer by the Rev. W. B. Hobling, Mr. Bowers congratulated the Church on the selection that had been made, for he believed that in Mr. Davies they would find both a leader and a teacher.—Mr. Ostmore followed, asking help for the Sunday School, which was urgently needed, as several former teachers had lately left the town.—After a few words from Mr. Kirkman, the Rev. T. Davies said he should want the sympathy of the congregation, and sometimes their forbearance; but he would always try to make the pulpit a power, while he would not neglect other departments of pastoral work.—The Revds. W. Stepney (Ilford) and W. B. Hobling, and Mr. McCappin, welcomed Mr. and Mrs. Davies to Barking; and after a few words from Mr. Air and Mr. Jackson, the meeting concluded.—During the evening several anthems were sung by the Choir, under the direction of Mr. Cutmore.

School Attendance Committee.—A meeting of the School Attendance Committee was held on Monday evening in the Town Hall. Present:—Capt. Glenny (in the chair), Messrs. Bowers, Gilderson, Jackson, Johnson, Hobling, Pearson, Reeds, and Smith; with Mr. Bloomfield (Clerk) and Mr. Lamb (Attendance Officer). There had been no meeting during the month of August, and the following statement was given of attendances during the month of July:—

		July 6th	13th	20th	27th.
On Register	..	1,617	1,615	1,622	1,616
Average	..	1,273	1,289	1,292	1,139
Present at all	..	1,496	1,464	1,490	1,421
Absent ..	..	119	121	132	175

There were 23 cases brought before the Committee, none of them having any special interest. A few parents, however, were old offenders, and the Committee ordered them to be summoned; but the greater number were discharged with a caution on promising to send their children to School.

A New Communion "Service." — On Sunday, the 16th inst., a new communion "service," composed by Mr. Henry Martin, was sung at St. Margaret's Church. In the opinion of competent Judges it is an excellent composition, and reflects great credit on Mr. Martin, who has also rendered many other useful services to the Choir of St. Margaret's Church.

I.O.G.T.: "Chelmsford" Lodge, No. 1866.—In connection with the 15th anniversary of the introduction of the Order into England, a temperance sermon was preached in Hall-street Chapel on Sunday afternoon, the 16th inst., by the Rev. W. M. Wardle, Worthy District Chaplain, taking as his text Hosea vii. 1, from which he preached an appropriate sermon. There was a fair congregation, and Miss Ada Wells, of Moulsham, presided at the harmonium. In the evening the first of a series of Gospel temperance meetings was held in the Lodge-room at the Co-operative Stores, which was crowded with an attentive and appreciative audience, the staircase being also filled with people.—The Rev. W. M. Wardle conducted the meeting; and after a portion of Scripture had been read by Bro. H. S. Church, and prayer offered by Bro. E. Last, earnest Gospel addresses were delivered by the Chairman and the Rev. G. C. Postans. The Choir sang a selection of hymns from the "Blue Ribbon Hymn Book."—At the usual session on Tuesday the Lodge was visited by a party of members from "Maldon" Lodge, who provided a capital entertainment, and at the close were heartily thanked for their visit. Refreshments were served to the visitors before leaving by Bro. T. Clift, of the Old Friars' Coffee Tavern, at the expense of the Lodge. The programme included cornet solos from Bro. Lewin, songs from Bros. Lewin and Everett and Sisters Strutt and Matthams, and recitations from Sis. Matthams and Bros. J. Everitt, Stowers, W. Everitt, and Corley. A very pleasant evening was spent by all present.

THE ONGAR STORES.

TEA! TEA!! TEA!!!
TRY HORIDE'S
2/-
NEW SEASON SPECIAL.

NEW GRASS BUTTER.
Splendid Pure ... 1s. per lb.
Very Fine ... 1s. 2d. per lb.

FINE RIPE OLD CHEESE, 8d. per lb.

PROPRIETOR—JOHN HORIDE.

ONGAR.

School Treat.—On Wednesday last, the 12th inst., the children attending the Church Schools enjoyed their annual festival. To the number of about 80 they assembled at the Church, where a short service was held, and an affectionate address delivered by the Rev. E. J. Reeve, at the conclusion of which they were marched to the Vicarage meadow, and indulged in the usual games till five o'clock, when an excellent tea, (with fruit, &c., was supplied to them. After tea Mr. H. Jones distributed a number of prizes for good conduct and regular attendance, the sports being kept up till dusk. There was a goodly company of the tradesmen and townspeople present during the evening, amongst the ladies being Mrs. Budworth, Mrs. Clay and party; Mrs. Grattan, Mrs. T. Ross, Mrs. and the Misses C. Mott, &c., &c.

Increase of Foot-and-Mouth Disease.—Inspector Robinson reported to the Magistrates at the Ongar Session on Saturday that during the last week foot-and-mouth disease had broken out at Cross Farm, Shellow, in the occupation of Mr. Richard Bush; of 17 pigs, 13 were affected, and four had died, and three cows were also affected.—The disease had also broken out at Widow's Farm, Stanford Rivers, in the occupation of Mr. W. Milbank.—Each of the places was declared an infected area, the Chairman remarking: It is a shocking thing, as it appears spreading very much in this district. I am sorry to hear it.

Accident.—On Friday afternoon, the 14th inst., as the Rev. Father Nicholls, Roman Catholic Priest, was out with a horse he had engaged on trial, on returning across Epping-green the animal took fright at some passing object, and on turning into the road the cart was smashed against a gate; but the driver and horse escaped unhurt.

EPPING.

Home Mission of the Church of England.—On Sunday, September 16th, special sermons were preached in the parish Church by the Rev. H. Hilliard, and collections taken on behalf of the above Society.

South Weald Harvest Festival.—The annual harvest festival was held in the parish Church on Sunday, the 16th inst. The Church was elaborately and tastefully decorated with fruit and flowers, and other specimens of the produce of the garden and field. The service, which was choral, was rendered in a devotional spirit by the Choir, assisted by the Choir of St. John's, Epping. The sermon in the evening was by the Rev. A. C. Roberts, Incumbent of St. John's, Epping, and was most appropriate to the occasion. The Church was inconveniently crowded, and some 200 persons stood in the Churchyard. Mr. J. C. Archer presided at the organ, and the Choir sang the anthems, "Ye shall dwell in the land" (Dr. Stainer) and the "Heavens are telling," from the *Creation*.

Harvest Festival.—Harvest thanksgiving was held in St. John's Church, High-street, on Wednesday evening. The ladies who undertook the work of decoration made everyone delighted with the effect produced. The contributes of fruit, flowers, vegetables, corn, and other produce was most profuse, the cottagers sending a good supply. The following ladies undertook the decorations:—Mrs. Roberts, Mrs. Hunter, Mrs. Fowler, Mrs. and Miss Tait, Mrs. and Miss Kelly, Mrs. and Miss Sworder, the Misses Humphrey, Winstin, Bell, and Brown, and Mr. J. Brown. The pulpit, which was done by Mrs. and Miss Sworder, was the admiration of all, and the effect handsome. The sermon was preached by the Ven. Archdeacon of Essex, who was assisted in the service by the Revds. A. C. Roberts (Incumbent), E. Buckmaster (Epping), J. Llewellyn, L. Cockerell (North Weald), and E. Fort (Coopersale). The preacher took for his text Psalm cxvi. 11, upon which he founded a most impressive discourse. He also made a powerful appeal for funds for the Eastern Counties' Asylum for Idiots, to which the offertory was devoted. The service was choral throughout, which was quite an innovation at this Church, but every part was well rendered by the Choir, assisted by the North Weald Choir, who sang with great effect Stainer's anthem, "Ye shall dwell in the land," and whilst the offertory was being taken, Haydn's chorus, "The Heavens are telling," under the leadership of Mr. M. Dunstain, Miss Odell presiding at the organ. This Church will hold nearly 800 persons, and upon this occasion was filled, and a large number of persons were compelled to stand during the service, whilst quite a crowd was outside in the street. The flowers and fruit were afterwards sent to the London Hospital.

Accident to an Epping Postman. — On Tuesday evening as Charles Brassell, the North Weald postman, was in his garden talking to his wife, he stepped on a small stone, and in the fall broke his leg. Dr. Fowler attended and set the limb; but it is feared that some long time must elapse before he is able to resume his duties.

HATFIELD BROAD OAK.

COTTAGERS' SHOW.

A very successful Show of vegetables, fruit, and flowers was held at Gladwyn's, near Hatfield Heath, the residence of Mr. Horace Broke, J.P., on Wednesday last, in a tent erected in a meadow, the gardens and grounds being also thrown open to the public. There were 79 exhibitors, who made about 180 entries. Several ladies and gentlemen materially added to the attractiveness of the Show by sending plants, flowers, fruit, or vegetables. Lady Broke Middleton (who with her husband, Sir George, were staying at Gladwyn's) showed a rarity in the shape of bananas, the fruit of a tropical plant, grown at Shrubland Park, Suffolk; Lady Selwin-Ibbetson, six boxes of cut flowers, and a sample of fresh butter from the Down Hall dairy; Mrs. Perry-Watlington, a choice collection of stove and greenhouse plants; Mr. Rivers (Sawbridgeworth), 17 varieties of useful sorts of apples (which he will doubtless take to the National Apple Congress next month, of which he is appointed a Commissioner) and a dozen superb peaches; the Rev. A. E. Seaman, several marrows, apples, and a variety of potatoes. Other contributors included Miss E. Glyn, the Rev. Canon Hill, the Rev. J. J. Baker (Little Hallingbury), Mr. C. G. Firman (Hatfield Town), Mrs. Stallibrass (Sheering), Mr. T. Barker (Hatfield Heath), Mr. T. Bass (Matching), and Mr. J. Bawn (Sheering). A specimen of honey was sent by F. Tadgell (Sheering). The attendance was large, including Sir Henry and Lady Selwin-Ibbetson, Sir William and Lady Wiseman, Mr., Mrs., and the Misses Glyn, Miss Parke and Miss Astley, Rev. R. M. and Mrs. Rodwell, Rev. A. and Mrs. Sandford, Canon Hill, Rev. A. E. and Mrs. Seaman, Rev. J. J. Baker, Rev. H. A. Lipscombe (Sawbridgeworth), Mr., Mrs., and Miss Firman, Mr. and Mrs. Wayre, Mr. S. S. and Miss Poole, Mr. and Mrs. W. Poole, Mr. and Mrs. Hordern, the Misses North, Mr. and Miss Silk, &c., &c.

Prior to the distribution of the prizes by Miss Margaret Broke, Sir William Wiseman remarked that Sir Henry Selwin-Ibbetson and Mr. Broke desired him to say that they hoped to have the Show on a more permanent footing. In future it would be held earlier, and more notice given, and there would be grafted on to it an industrial exhibition, with a view of developing the latent talent of the villages around.—Cheers were given at the close for Sir William Wiseman and Lady Selwin-Ibbetson and Mrs. Broke, who had taken great interest in the show.

The Judges were Mr. Spivey (gardener to Mr. John Archer Houblon) and Mr. William Camp (manager to Messrs. T. Rivers and Son); the Rev. R. M. Rodwell being Referee. The cut flowers were judged by Miss E. Glyn; the bread by Mrs. T. W. Brown; and the gardens by Canon Hill and Mr. S. S. Poole.

LIST OF PRIZES.

Plants in Pots.—Two of any kind: 1, Robert Pomeroy, Sheering; 2, Israel Adams, Hatfield Heath. Single plant: 1, I. Adams; 2, Elias Sapsford, Hatfield Heath; 3, W. Bass, Matching Tye.

Cut Flowers.—Four roses: 1, Charles Norris, Sheering; 2, Esau Sapsford, Hatfield Heath. Nosegay of garden flowers: 1, W. Bird, Sheering; 2, Elias Sapsford; 3, Esau Sapsford. Nosegay of wild flowers: 1, William Challis, Hatfield Heath; 2, Emily Prior, Sheering; 3, Ernest Shipton, Sheering; extra, Annie Norris and Ethel Bacon, Sheering.

Vegetables and Fruits.—Twelve round potatoes: 1, Charles French, Sheering; 2, Charles Whitbread, Sheering; 3, George Day, Hatfield Heath. Twelve kidney ditto: 1, George Dennis, Matching Tye; 2, Wm. Bass; 3, Wm. Bird. Twenty-four onions: 1, Elias Sapsford; 2, George Day; 3, Wm. Tucker, Matching Tye. Twenty-four carrots: 1, B. French, Hatfield Heath; 2, William Feisted, Matching; 3, George Clark, Hatfield Heath. Twelve parsnips: 1, William Bass; 2, Charles French; 3, William Tucker. White turnips: 1, John Brown, Matching; 2, Alfred Byford, Matching Tye; 3, Charles Norris. Four Savoys: 1, W. Bass; 2, William Feisted; 3, Elias Sapsford. Twenty-four apples: 1, Edward Shipton, Sheering (from a tree said to be nearly 100 years old); 2, Joshua Brown, Matching Tye; 3, James Shipton, Sheering. Two vegetable marrows: 1, Esau Sapsford; 2, John Clanford, Sheering. Pickling cabbage: 1, Alfred Byford; 2, John Brown; 3, James Curtis, Newman End. Two pumpkins: 1, James Monk, Sheering; 2, William Prior, Hatfield Heath; 3, W. Feisted.

Bread.—1, Mrs. George Mortlock, Sheering; 2, Mrs. Prior, Hatfield Heath; 3, Mrs. Charles Tadgell, Sheering.

Gardens.—Best kept garden and hedge: 1, George Dennis, Matching Tye; 2, Charles French, Sheering; 3, William Feisted, Matching.

GRAYS.

School Board Meeting.—At a meeting of the School Board on Thursday evening, Sept. 13th, Mr. E. W. Brooks, who presided, stated that he had applied to the Education Department for advice as to supplimenting the salaries of teachers at the Elementary Schools from the rates, should the children's pence be insufficient. He was informed positively that no such arrangement could be made unless the management of the Schools was placed in the hands of the Board.—A resolution arrived at at a previous meeting, authorising Mrs. Marr, Mistress of the Girls' Elementary School, and her teachers, to draw their salaries from the children's pence, and to come to the School Board for the deficiency, if any, was thereupon rescinded.

Harvest Festival at Little Thurrock.—On Tuesday evening a harvest thanksgiving service was held at the parish Church. A very large congregation was present. The Rev. Thomas Romaine Govitt (late Vicar of Newmarket) preached from Jeremiah viii. 20. The anthem, by Fairbrother, was very sweetly sung. The offertory for the London Hospital amounted to nearly £5.

Anniversary Sermons.—On Sunday, Sept. 16th, anniversary sermons were preached at the Primitive Methodist Chapel, New Road, by the Rev. T. Polworth, of Romford, before large congregations.

Assaulting a Policeman.—*Edward Hook*, a dock labourer, of Gravesend, was remanded before the Rev. Cornwall Smalley, on Monday last, on a charge of assaulting p.-c. Hurrell on the previous Saturday till to-day (Friday).

Shocking Accident. — A painful accident occurred on the premises of Messrs. Stansfield and Co., ironfounders, of Grays, on Tuesday evening last. While a gang of men were engaged in moving some machinery by means of a heavy travelling crane, the crane suddenly toppled over, felling them to the ground. George Clarke had his right thigh smashed, besides receiving severe internal injuries, whilst Harry Staines had his arms broken and his scalp lacerated. The injured men were removed to the London Hospital.

A Deserter.—*Frederick Root* was apprehended at Chelmsford, on Tuesday, by p.-c. Woodcock, and charged with being an absentee from the Essex Regiment, stationed at Warley. He was sent back to his Regiment on Wednesday.

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